



Still Registered, Rarely Ridden

Interviewing Bike-Rack Permit-Holders Against an Index That Only Climbs

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The problem

Despite growing institutional confidence in permit-based participation metrics, little is known about what happens to a bike-rack registration once its holder stops riding — or whether anyone ever tells the index.

Research questions

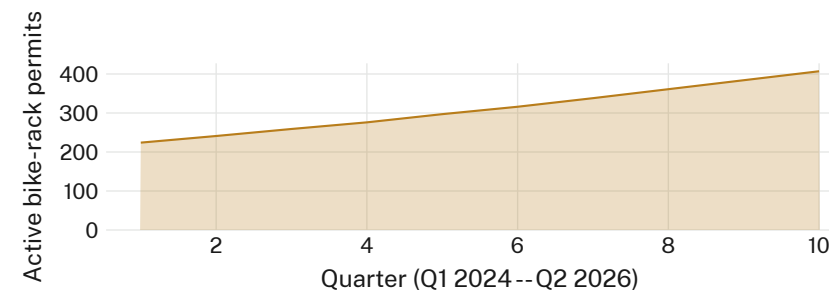
- What share of active bike-rack permit-holders still cycle to campus?
- How does the permit register track against the University's own termly ridership survey?
- Why do lapsed riders keep an active permit?

Approach

- $n = 38$ active permit-holders, stratified by building · semi-structured interview
- Transcripts coded to a lapsed / current riding-status framework, two coders blind to building ($\kappa = 0.79$)
- Permit-register and Travel & Parking Survey trends held as independent administrative baselines, neither adjusted post hoc

Findings

Interview-reported riding frequency showed only a weak association with active permit status ($r = 0.34$); the register climbed every quarter regardless.



Active bike-rack permits rose from 224 to 407 between Q1 2024 and Q2 2026; self-reported regular riders in the same termly Travel & Parking Survey held between 147 and 172 across the same period.

Implications

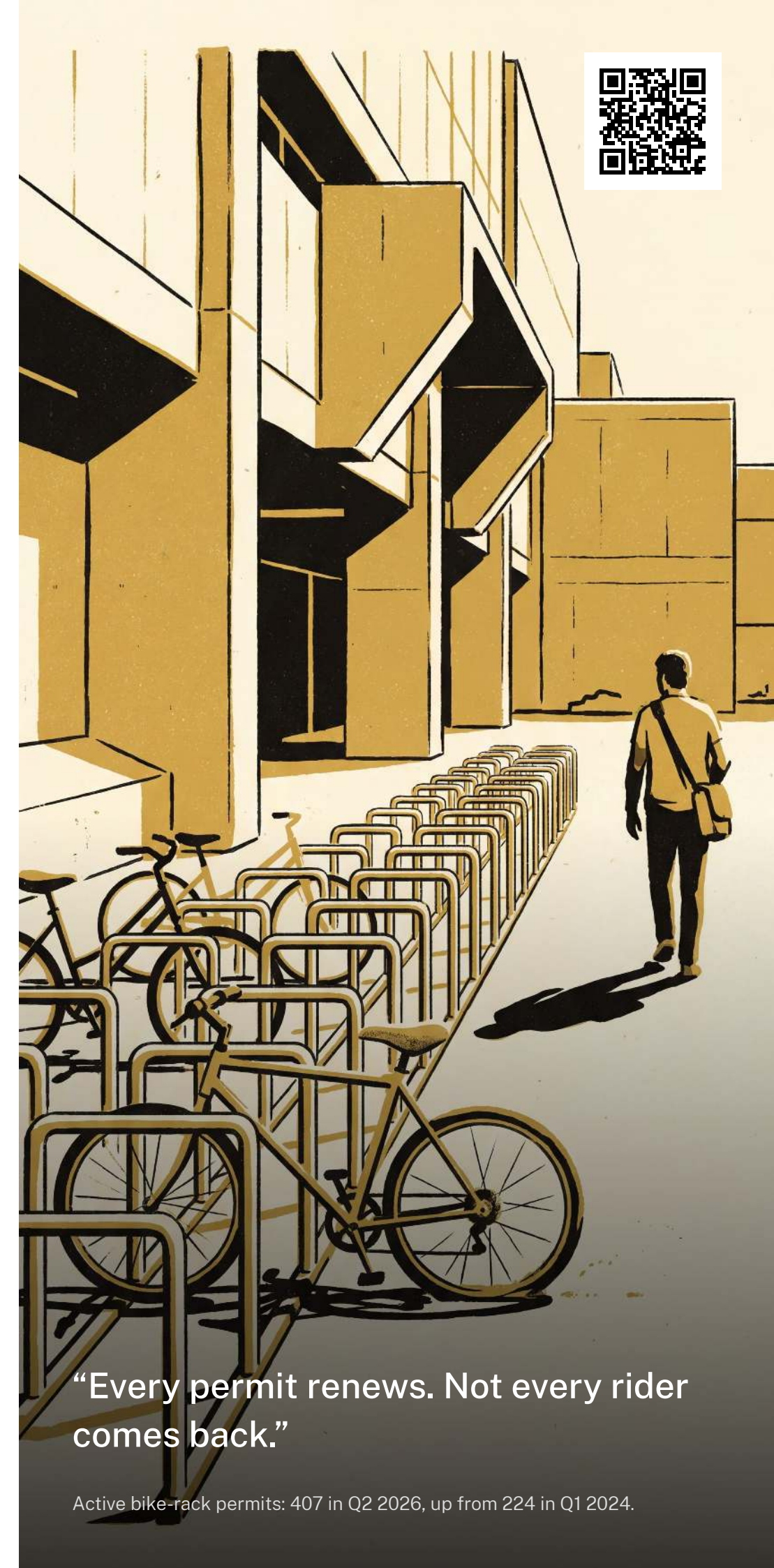
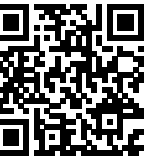
The register counts registrations, not rides. A permit lapses only on a filed cancellation form, and nothing in the renewal cycle prompts one. Next: default-expiring permits, renewed on confirmed use.

Selected references

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Interview transcripts de-identified; permit and survey extracts held in aggregate only.

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“Every permit renews. Not every rider comes back.”

Active bike-rack permits: 407 in Q2 2026, up from 224 in Q1 2024.